Persona

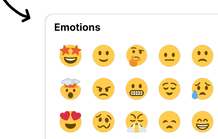
Overextended Early-Career Networker

Scenario

A college senior meets a recruiter at a networking event, plans to follow up later, but forgets and struggles to reconnect when time passes.

Expectations

- I will remember to follow up with new contacts at the right time
- I will easily recall what we discussed
- Reaching out will feel natural and professional
- My networking efforts will lead to meaningful next steps
- Important relationships will not slip through the cracks

	Phase 1 - TRIGGER	Phase 2 - AWARNESS	Phase 3 - DECISION & ACTION	Phase 4 - OUTCOME
User actions	• Attends a networking event and meets a professional contact • Has a positive conversation • Intends to follow up in the future • Leaves event intending to follow up, but doesn't define specific next step while conversation is fresh	• Weeks pass while the user gets busy • Later remembers the contact when something brings them back to the conversation • Realizes they never followed up • Decides to deal with it later because it isn't urgent in the moment	• Debates whether to reach out • Tries to remember what was discussed and what the next step was • Decides whether reacing out now will feel 'too late' or unprofessional. • Tires to decide what the message should accomplish now • Either sends a delayed message or avoids it entirely	• **If they reached out**: Waits for a response and interprets silence/response • **If they didn't**: Mentally writes it off and avoids engaging again • **Reflection**: Leaves with a takeaway about follow-through
Touchpoints	• In-person conversation • Business card or LinkedIn profile • Phone notes (informal)	• Calendar (sometimes) • LinkedIn connections • Personal memory • Excel spreadsheet (if used)	• Draft email or LinkedIn message • Notes app • Inbox • Excel spreadsheet	• Email / LinkedIn notifications (if outreach was sent)
Emotions	🙂	😐	☹️	😞
Pain points	• No clear system to track follow-ups • No reminder is set • Details of the conversation are not saved in one place • Underestimates how fast details and momentum fade	• Unsure of the right timing for a follow up • Immediately wonders if it's already too late • Doesn't remember conversation details • Information is scattered across apps	• Fear of seeming unprofessional • Hard to reconstruct next steps • Unclear on the purpose of the follow-up after the delay • Takes too much time and mental effort • Momentum from the original conversation is lost	• Relationship loses momentum • Missed opportunity for referral or mentorship • Reduced confidence in future networking • "Silence/not reaching out reinforces avoidance, making future contact difficult
Possible solutions	• Add the person on LinkedIn • Write a quick note in phone • Tell themselves they will remember later	• Scroll through old messages or emails • Try to reconstruct details from memory • Consider sending a generic message	• Use a generic outreach template • Ask a friend for advice • Put it off for later (again)	• Immediately log new networking contacts after meeting • Save conversation context and next steps in one place • Set a specific follow-up reminder for the exact date • Receive notifications at the right time • Reach out confidently with stored notes • Maintain relationships instead of forgetting them

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